

What to Do Before Your Home Hits the Market

Not every improvement is worth making before you list. This checklist helps you focus your time and money where buyers will actually notice

FIRST IMPRESSION

- ☐ Walk your home like a buyer
- ☐ Evaluate curb appeal (entry, walkway)
- ☐ Refresh front door (paint or hardware)
- ☐ Clear and simplify the entry space
- ☐ Add subtle warmth (plant, fresh mat)

CLEAN & DECLUTTER

- ☐ Deep clean (or hire a professional)
- ☐ Clear countertops
- ☐ Remove excess furniture to open space
- ☐ Organize closets (buyers will look)
- ☐ Eliminate odors completely

LIGHT & COLOR

- ☐ Maximize natural light (open blinds & drapes)
- ☐ Replace dim or mismatched bulbs
- ☐ Use warm, neutral tones where needed
- ☐ Touch up paint in high-traffic areas
- ☐ Remove overly bold or distracting colors

REPAIRS & MAINTENANCE

- ☐ Fix anything obviously broken
- ☐ Replace burned out bulbs
- ☐ Patch nail holes and minor wall damage
- ☐ Address any deferred maintenance
- ☐ Test smoke and carbon monoxide detectors
- ☐ Make sure windows / doors open and close

PRESENTATION

- ☐ Remove personal photos
- ☐ Add fresh towels and simple accessories
- ☐ Make all beds with clean, neutral bedding
- ☐ Remove pet items from visible areas

Have questions about what's worth doing before you list? I'm happy to talk it through